MIL-C-87972A
7 December 1987
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-87972
4 May 1984

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CASTERS, RIGID AND SWIVEL, GENERAL SPECIFICATION FOR

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers rigid and swivel casters for aircraft maintenance stands in flightline use.

1.2 Classification. Items covered by this specification are identified as follows:

Caster assembly, swivel
Caster assembly, rigid
Wheel assembly

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-576 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated, Veneer, Paper Overlaid
PPP-B-585 - Box, Wood, Wirebound
PPP-B-591 - Boxes, Shipping Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: San Antonio Air Logistics Center, AFLC: SA-ALC/MMEDO, Kelly AFB, Texas 78241-5990 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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FEDERAL

PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner
PPP-T-60 - Tape, Packaging, Waterproof

MILITARY

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods of
MIL-B-121 - Barrier Material, Greaseproofed, Waterproofed, Flexible
MIL-F-3541 - Fitting, Lubrication
MIL-M-8090 - Mobility, Towed Aerospace Ground Equipment, General Requirements for
MIL-L-10547 - Liner, Case and Sheet, Overwrap, Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible
MIL-G-10924 - Grease, Automotive and Artillery

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-601 - Rubber: Sampling and Testing

MILITARY

DOD-STD-100 - Engineering Drawing Practices
MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-130 - Identification Marking of U.S. Military Property
MIL-STD-794 - Parts and Equipment, Procedures for Packaging of
MIL-STD-808 - Finish Material and Processes for Corrosion Prevention and Control in Support Equipment
MIL-STD-810 - Environmental Test Methods
MIL-STD-831 - Test Reports, Preparation of
MIL-STD-889 - Dissimilar Metals
MIL-STD-1186 - Cushioning, Anchoring, Bracing, Blocking and Waterproofing, with Appropriate Test Methods

(Copies of specifications, standards, handbooks, drawings, publications and other Government documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issue of the non-government documents which is current on the date of the solicitation.

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ASTM

ASTM D3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging
ASTM A48 - Grey Iron Castings

(Application for copies should be addressed to ASTM, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

AMERICAN NATIONAL STANDARDS INSTITUTE (ANSI)

ANSI Y14.5M - Dimensioning and Tolerancing

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American National Standards Institute, 1430 Broadway New York, NY 10018.)

(Non-government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein (except for associated specification sheets), the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified, samples shall be submitted to the activity designated in the contract or purchase order for first article inspection to determine conformance to the requirements of this specification (see 4.3 and 6.2).

3.2 Components. The casters shall consist of the following components:

a. Mounting plate
b. Horn assembly
c. Wheel assembly
d. Kingpin

3.3 Material. The material shall be as specified herein. However, when a definite material is not specified, a material shall be used which will enable the casters to meet the performance requirements of this specification. Acceptance or approval of any constituent material shall not be construed as a guaranty of the acceptance of the finished product.

3.3.1 Dissimilar metals. When dissimilar metals are used in intimate contact, suitable protection against galvanic corrosion shall be applied in accordance with MIL-STD-889. Determination of dissimilar metals shall be as defined in MIL-STD-889.

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3.3.2 Protective finish. Materials used in the construction of the casters shall be suitably finished to provide corrosion protection against the performance requirements specified herein and in normal conditions of use, storage and exposure. The protective finish shall be stable and durable, shall not crack, chip, flake, powder or scale, and shall not interfere with the applicable performance requirements specified herein and in accordance with MIL-STD-808.

3.3.3 Recycled, virgin and reclaimed materials. There is no requirement that an item be manufactured from virgin materials.

3.4 Design. The casters shall be plate mounted, single wheeled, solid rubber tired, in accordance with Figure 1 or Figure 2.

3.5 Construction. The casters shall be so constructed that no parts will work loose in service. They shall be designed to withstand the strains, jars, vibrations, and other conditions incident to shipping, storage, installation, and service for which it is intended (see 6.1).

3.5.1 Mounting plate. The mounting plate shall be made of carbon steel, and be a flat plate type.

3.5.2 Horn assembly. The horn assembly shall be made of carbon steel. On swivel casters, the horn assembly shall be assembled to the mounting plate to permit independent continuous 360 degree rotation around the vertical axis.

3.5.3 Kingpin. The kingpin for swivel casters shall be made of hardened steel and so secured that in swiveling it will not rotate in frictional contact with component members of the swivel bearing assembly. Kingpin and swivel assemblies shall be designed to permit fine adjustment of the swivel bearings. Kingpin shall be secured to top plate by a continuous all-around weld at top or bottom, or be integrally forged as part of the top plate, machined and threaded.

3.5.4 Wheel assembly. Wheel assemblies shall have a rubber tread securely vulcanized to the core. The outer dimension of the wheel assembly with the bearings and suitable thrust washers (see 3.5.6.2) shall comply with the dimensions in Figure 1 and Figure 2.

3.5.4.1 Tread. The tread shall be vulcanized natural rubber or manufactured rubber having a durometer A hardness of 70 to 85 (see 3.6.7).

3.5.4.2 Spare wheels. When specified, wheels shall be procured as spare parts (see 6.2).

3.5.4.3 Core. The core shall be machined from carbon steel or cast from gray iron per ASTM A48, Class 25 or 30. A zerk type lubricating fitting (see 3.5.6.1.1) shall be provided that will permit the wheel bearings to be lubricated with a standard grease gun without any disassembly of the casters.

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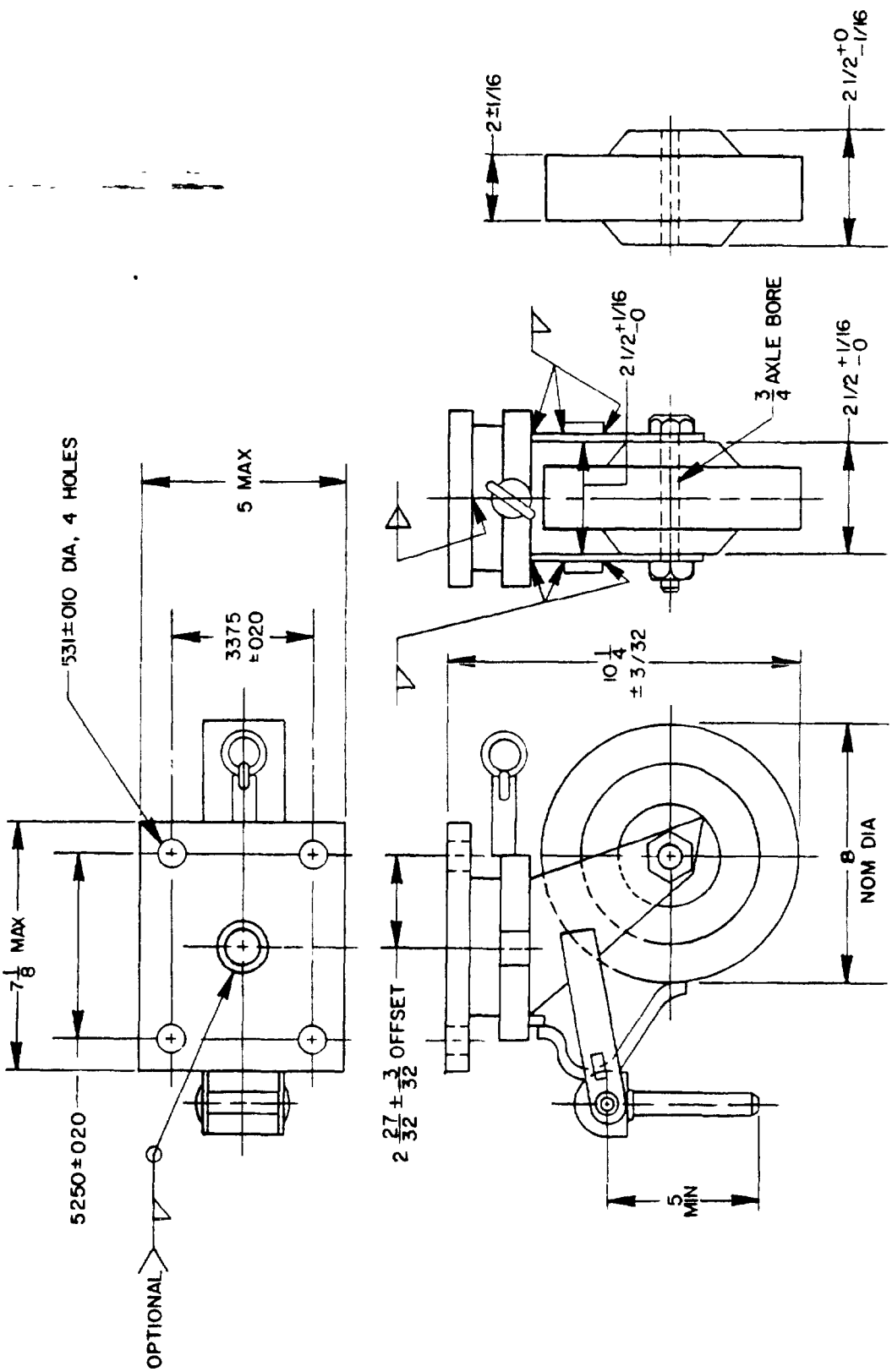


FIGURE 1

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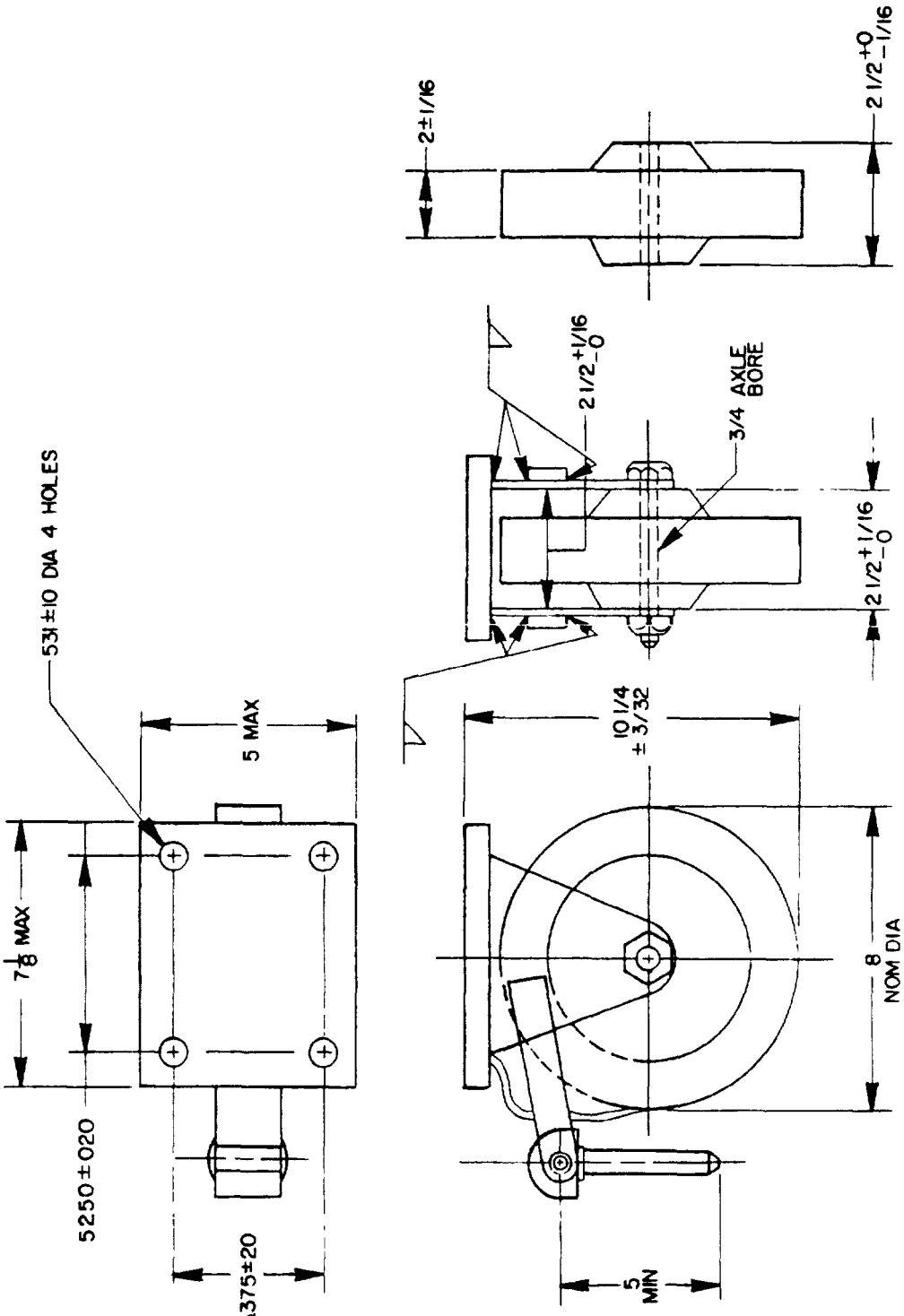


FIGURE 2

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3.5.5 Lubrication. Wheel and swivel bearings shall be adequately lubricated upon assembly with grease in accordance with MIL-M-8090. Use of permanent life-time lubricated bearings is prohibited.

3.5.6 Bearings.

3.5.6.1 Main swivel bearings. On swivel casters the main thrust-load swivel bearing shall be of the flat plate, single row, roller type or single row of hardened carbon steel ball bearings rotating in hardened machined raceways, with lubrication fitting. The kingpin shall be equipped with a taper type roller thrust bearing.

3.5.6.1.1 Lubrication fitting. On swivel casters the main swivel bearing lubrication fitting shall be a zerk-type lubrication fitting with a check ball and a spring in accordance with MIL-F-3541. The lubrication fitting shall be located under the main bearing and shall be accessible to a standard grease gun without any disassembly of the caster.

3.5.6.2 Wheel bearings. Wheel bearings shall be replaceable precision, high speed tapered roller bearing assemblies. The bearings shall be designed in such a way that a preload can be applied through the cone without coming in contact with the cup of the bearing. A hardened inner race, suitable thrust washers and a zerk-type pressure lube fitting (see 3.5.6.1.1) shall be provided.

3.5.7 Swivel lock. Swivel casters shall be equipped with a plunger type swivel lock that will lock the caster in at least four positions: 0°, 90°, 180°, 270°. When engaged, the swivel lock shall prevent the caster from swiveling while rolling and while at right angles to the normal path of travel. When disengaged, the swivel lock shall be locked out and permit full 360° free swiveling during operation.

3.5.8 Wheel brake. When specified (see 6.2) brakes shall be foot activated or handle type, and shall not slip when tested (see 4.5.2).

3.5.9 Axle. The axle shall be made of hardened steel and shall be so designed that no threads protrude on the bearing surface and that it will not rotate or become loosened under normal use. A castellated hexagon nut and a cotter key will be provided as a means of securing the wheel. The axle will be quickly and easily removable to allow changing of the wheel. A hole shall be placed in the threaded end for use with the cotter pin.

3.6 Performance.

3.6.1 Humidity. There shall be no evidence of corrosion or failure of finish (see 4.5.3.3).

3.6.2 Salt fog. There shall be no evidence of bearing failure, corrosion or failure of finishes (see 4.5.3.4).

3.6.3 Sand and dust. There shall be no evidence of dust particles in the bearings of wheel or swivel and no failure of finish (see 4.5.3.5).

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3.6.4 Static load. There shall be no evidence of damage or permanent deformation after the static load test (see 4.5.4).

3.6.5 Tread hardness. The tread material shall meet the hardness requirements of 3.5.4 (see 4.5.6).

3.6.6 Part numbering of interchangeable parts. All parts having the same manufacturer's part number shall be functionally and dimensionally interchangeable. The item identification and part number requirements of DOD-STD-100 shall govern the manufacturer's part numbers and changes thereto.

3.6.7 Dimensions. The dimensions shall be as specified in Figures 1 and 2, and in accordance with ANSI Y14.5M.

3.6.8 Identification of product. Equipment, assemblies, and parts shall be marked for identification in accordance with MIL-STD-130.

3.6.9 Welding. Welding shall be sound, free from porosity or cracks or incomplete fusion, deformation of the metal, or rough and projecting edges. Where steel above 0.40 carbon content is welded in fabrication, a subsequent heat treatment for stress relief, or preheating, or low hydrogen electrodes shall be used to provide maximum physical properties in the joint.

3.6.10 Workmanship. Casters, including all parts and accessories shall be fabricated and finished using production industrial equipment. Parts and assemblies shall be free of blemishes, defects, burrs and sharp edges.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of Sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products of supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

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4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows;

a. First article inspection (see 4.3)
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4)

4.3 First article inspection. Three samples shall be submitted for first article inspection in accordance with Table I.

TABLE I. FIRST ARTICLE INSPECTION

INSPECTION	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	TEST METHOD PARAGRAPH
Examination	-	4.5.1
Static load	3.6.4	4.5.4

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Quality conformance inspection shall be in accordance with Table II.

TABLE II. QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

INSPECTION	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	TEST METHOD PARAGRAPH
Group A		
Examination	1/	4.5.1
Group B		
Brake test	3.5.8	4.5.3
Humidity	3.6.1	4.5.4.1
Static load	3.6.4	4.5.5
Tread hardness	3.6.5	4.5.6
Group C		
Salt fog	3.6.2	4.5.4.2
Sand and dust	3.6.3	4.5.4.3

1/ All requirements not covered by tests.

4.4.1 Inspection lot. An inspection lot shall consist of all casters produced under essentially the same conditions, and offered for inspection at one time.

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4.4.2 Rejected lots. If an inspection lot is rejected, the contractor may rework it to correct the defects, or screen out the defective units and resubmit for reinspection. Resubmitted lots shall be inspected using tightened inspection. Such lots shall be separate from new lots, and shall be clearly identified as reinspected lots.

4.4.3 Sampling for Group A inspection. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 Inspection Level II with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 1.5 percent defective for major defects. For minor defects, Inspection Level I with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective shall apply.

4.4.3.1 Classification of defects. Defects shall be classified as specified in Table III.

TABLE III. CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS

CATEGORY	DEFECT
Critical	None defined
Major	
101	Zerk-type lubrication fittings missing
102	Improperly assembled
103	Bowed, bent, buckled or otherwise deformed
104	Wheel bearings or swivel bearings bind when rotated
105	Tire loose on wheel
106	Welds contain cracks, burnt holes, porosity, or incomplete fusion
107	Welds contain pits or fissures
Minor	
201	Tire contains blisters, pits, cracks, porosity, gouges, checks or discoloration
202	Evidence of rust or corrosion
203	Not treated or painted as applicable
204	Dimensions not in accordance with Figure 1
205	Burrs and sharp edges
206	Threads stripped
207	Marking incomplete, not legible, not permanent, not located as specified

4.4.4 Sampling for Group B inspection. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Inspection Level S-2 with an AQL of 2.5 percent defective and may be made on sample units which have been subjected to and have passed Group A inspection.

4.4.4.1 Disposition of sample units. Sample units which have passed all the Group B inspection may be delivered on the contract or purchase order if the lot is accepted and the sample units are still within specified requirements.

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4.4.5 Sampling for Group C inspection. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Inspection Level S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective.

4.4.5.1 Disposition of sample units. Sample units which have been subjected to Group C inspection shall not be delivered on the contract.

4.5 Methods of inspection.

4.5.1 Examination. Sample casters shall be thoroughly examined to determine conformance with this specification with respect to all requirements not covered by tests.

4.5.2 Test fixture. The following test fixture shall be used for the brake (4.5.3) and static load (4.5.4) tests. A platform or circular or triangular design shall be used. The platform shall be capable of supporting a minimum of 2,500 pounds and have a means of securing three caster assemblies utilizing all four mounting bolt holes in the top plate. The casters shall be positioned in such a manner that when the load is applied to the platform, it will be equally distributed through each caster. When a total of 500 pounds is required for a caster, a total of 1,500 pounds will be used to accomplish the test and when 800 pounds is required for a caster 2,400 pounds will be used to accomplish the test.

4.5.3 Brake. Brakes shall be tested as follows: The caster shall be loaded to 500 lbs and the brakes applied. The brakes shall hold the caster wheel motionless whether headed up or down on a dry, concrete, 20 degree incline. The brakes shall be installed on the caster when subjected to the environmental tests described in 4.5.3. At the conclusion of these tests, the brakes shall be examined. Band separation or other damage shall be cause for rejection.

4.5.4 Environmental tests. The following tests shall be conducted in accordance with the specified procedures of MIL-STD-810.

4.5.4.1 Humidity. The caster shall be subjected to humidity in accordance with Method 507.2, procedure I, non-hazardous items, natural cycle 1, Table 507.2-II of MIL-STD-810D.

4.5.4.2 Salt fog. The caster shall be subjected to salt fog in accordance with Method 509, procedure I for a period of 50 hours. There shall be no substantial evidence of corrosion, bearing failure, or failure of coatings or finishes.

4.5.4.3 Sand and dust. The caster shall be subjected to sand and dust in accordance with Method 510.2, procedure I (blowing dust) of MIL-STD-810D. A velocity of 1500 to 2000 fpm for steps 2 and 7 and a temperature of 63C (1451) for step 5 are considered acceptable for this procedure. At the conclusion of the test, there shall be no evidence of dust particles in the bearings of either the wheels or the swivel and no failure of coatings or finishes.

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4.5.5 Static load test. Caster, without the rubber tread, shall be subjected to the static load test. A static proof load equal to the rated load of 500 pounds shall be applied through the top plate of the caster by means of weights or a press for a period of 15 minutes followed by a static ultimate load of 800 pounds for a period of 15 minutes. The caster assembly shall then be inspected to determine that no damage or permanent deformation has occurred. Any damage or permanent deformation in the caster assembly shall be cause for rejection.

4.5.6 Tread hardness test. The hardness of the tread as received shall be measured on the face of the tread by a Type A Shore durometer and shall be 75 ±10 points when tested according to FED-STD-601, Method 3021.

4.5.7 First article test report. When specified, the contractor shall prepare a report of the first article tests in accordance with MIL-STD-831 (see 6.3).

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation and packaging. Preservation and packaging shall be Level A, C or industrial/commercial packaging (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging. Casters shall be preserved in accordance with Method 1 of MIL-P-116. Ball or roller antifriction bearings shall be adequately lubricated with a preservative grease conforming to MIL-G-10924. Each caster shall be wrapped in Grade A greaseproof barrier material conforming to MIL-B-121 and further overwrapped with kraft paper, 60 pound (24 by 36) to prevent abrasion. Unit quantities shall be as specified by the procuring activity.

5.1.2 Level C. Casters shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with the MIL-STD-794.

5.1.3 Industrial/commercial. Casters shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with ASTM-D-3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be Level A, B, C or industrial/commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Casters preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packaged in exterior shipping containers conforming to PPP-B-576, Style B, Class 2, PPP-B-585, Style 3, PPP-B-601, Overseas Type, or PPP-B-621, Class 2. As far as practical, exterior container shall be of uniform shape and size, of minimum cube and tare consistent with the protection required, and shall contain identical quantities. The gross weight of each pack shall be limited to approximately 200 pounds. Containers shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the applicable container specification or appendix thereto.

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Flat steel strapping shall be Type I, Class B. Container shall be provided with a case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547 and shall be sealed in accordance with the appendix thereto. The case liner will not be required when the unit, intermediate, or exterior container is sealed at all joints and seams, including the manufacturer's joint, with tape conforming to PPP-T-60.

5.2.2 Level B. Casters preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in domestic type exterior containers conforming to PPP-B-576, PPP-B-591, PPP-B-601 or PPP-B-621. Exterior containers shall be of minimum cube and tare consistent with the protection required. As far as practical, exterior containers shall be of uniform shape and size and shall contain identical quantities. The gross weight of each pack shall be limited to approximately 500 pounds. Containers shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the applicable container specification or appendix thereto.

5.2.3 Level C. Packages which require overpacking for acceptance by the carrier shall be packed in accordance with MIL-STD-794.

5.2.4 Industrial/commercial. Casters shall be packed in accordance with ASTM-D-3951.

5.3 Physical protection. Cushioning, blocking, bracing and bolting as required shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1186 except for domestic shipment, waterproofing requirements for cushioning materials and containers shall be waived. The drop tests of MIL-STD-1186 shall be waived when preservation and packaging, and packing of the item are for immediate use or when the drop tests of MIL-P-116 are applicable.

5.4 Marking. Interior and exterior containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. The nomenclature shall be: Caster, Swivel or Caster, Rigid.

5.4.1 Levels A, B and C. Marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.4.2 Industrial/commercial. Marking shall be in accordance with ASTM D3951.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The casters covered by this specification are intended for use on flight line aircraft maintenance stands, where the stands are subject to adverse environmental conditions of heat, cold, rain and dust, and require towing up to 20 mph, and be capable of towing loads up to 500 lbs.

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6.2 Ordering data.

6.2.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.

b. Specify swivel or rigid caster.

c. Quantity of spare wheels.

d. Whether first article testing is required and where testing will be performed.

e. Where test records, if specified, shall be forwarded.

f. Preservation, packaging, packing level and marking.

6.3 First article. When specified, (see 6.2), and as soon as practicable after the award of the contract or order, first article samples shall be separately packaged and forwarded to the testing activity indicated in the contract or order, who shall have the responsibility for testing to determine compliance with the requirements of this specification and notifying the procuring activity of approval or disapproval. Samples shall be plainly identified by securely attached durable tags, marked with the following information:

a. Samples for first article inspection
b. Contract or order number
c. Specification number
d. Manufacturer's part number
e. Name of manufacturer

6.4 Keyword listing.

Caster assembly, swivel
Caster assembly, rigid
Wheel assembly

6.5 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks (or vertical lines) are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

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(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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